

Canon LBP-5000

Too expensive

Canon's LBP-5000 is priced at Rs 29,999, so it doesn't fit in the entry-level segment. It's more of a mid-range colour laser. Canon has taken a minimalist design approach, which is OK, but we would have liked an LCD. The two-tone colour is nice, and the clean lines help hide its bulk. The 250-sheet paper tray fits snugly.

Eight LEDs indicate different problems such as paper jam, toner empty, warnings, etc. There are no buttons; this is strange, considering the lack of an LCD. The driver is comprehensive, though, and additional features such as watermarking, manual duplexing, etc., are certainly there. Instead of basing printing on dpi, Canon uses presets such as Graphics, General, etc., and a help box to inform you when to use them. Canon's status window is still the best across the printers we tested.

While installing the drivers, our machine hung, but a restart fixed it. The LBP-5000 has a single-pass engine, so paper

jams are few. Canon claims 8 ppm for both black and colour, and our tests revealed speeds of 7 ppm for black and 6 ppm for colour—commendable. The Combi-document took 23 seconds to print.

In terms of quality, the LBP-5000 delivers results as good as the HP LaserJet 2600n. 2-point text is clearly legible, reverse text (yellow on black) printed well, colour gradations were smooth across colour bands, and even the photo document was flawlessly reproduced with minimal



loss of detail or tonal deviation.

Cartridges cost Rs 17,680. The ratings say you will get 2,500 black prints, and that colour cartridges are good for 2,000 prints. The cost per page works out to Rs 1.60 for black and Rs 2.24 for colour, which is really expensive.

The Canon LBP-5000 delivers on speed and print quality, but loses out badly on price—in terms of initial investment as well as running costs.

Specifications

600 dpi; 8 ppm (black and colour); 8 MB memory plus system memory used; 250-sheet paper cassette; USB 2.0; optional Ethernet

Price: Rs 29,999

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Print Speed	★★★★☆
Print Quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★★

HP LaserJet 2605dn

Quality print but slow

The LaserJet 2605dn is HP's upmarket model from the 2600 series, but with additional features. It looks identical to the LaserJet 2600n, though under the hood it adds a duplexing unit.

The paper cassette holds up to 250 sheets, and you can manually feed in a single sheet at a time. The duplexing capability can be activated automatically via the driver, and is unchecked by default. Duplexing helps reduce paper usage and is useful when printing, say, an e-book.

Installation was child's play, and took no more than ten minutes. HP's toolkit allows a user to administer the printer and set various options such as paper type and size, toner density, etc. We had no problems setting it up on a network either—a network address is directly added using the onboard controls or via the toolkit. There is a plethora of options for managing the printer remotely—great for system administrators.

HP claims a speed of 12 ppm for black, but it only managed 8



in our test. The six-page colour document took 2 minutes to complete—really slow. The Combi-document took 34 seconds to print, and the photo document took 48 seconds. Overall, the LaserJet 2605dn was a really slow printer.

What it lost in speed, it made up for in terms of quality. The text document printed flawlessly, and the Combi-document saw every element reproduced as displayed on our screens. This is also the first colour laser printer we've seen that matched an inkjet's ability to reproduce

skin tone correctly.

The LaserJet 2605dn is priced at Rs 26,999, and the total cost of the cartridges comes to Rs 13,515. According to the rated yield of the cartridges, the cost per page works out similar to that of the LaserJet 2600n—reasonable!

The HP LaserJet 2605dn has good features, is reasonably priced for the features on offer, and produces excellent print-outs. The only gripe we have is the relatively slow print speed; except for that, the 2605dn is a good buy.

Specifications

12 ppm (black and colour); 8 MB memory plus system memory used; 250-sheet paper cassette; USB 2.0; optional Ethernet

Price: Rs 26,999

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Print Speed	★★★★☆
Print Quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★★

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